

Lesson 09

Case Study: Chairing a Meeting



Warm-Up

Discussion:

1. What are some of your experiences with effective meetings?
2. What makes a meeting successful?
3. What effective communication strategies do you expect from the chairperson of the meeting?



Case Study

The I.T. Department held a critical meeting to discuss the upcoming software deployment. However, the meeting quickly became an example of poor management, highlighting several key issues that hindered its effectiveness.

The meeting was scheduled on short notice, and many team members were not adequately prepared. The agenda was not shared in advance, leaving participants unsure of the topics to be discussed. As a result, the meeting started with confusion, and valuable time was spent clarifying the purpose and scope of the discussion.

Another issue observed during the meeting was that it was intended to last one hour, but it extended well beyond the allotted time. The facilitator failed to manage the discussion effectively, allowing certain topics to dominate the conversation while others were neglected.

Communication during the meeting was another major issue. Some team members dominated the conversation, while others struggled to voice their opinions. The lack of a structured approach to ensure equal participation resulted in important perspectives being overlooked.

Case Study Analysis:

1. What were the three lapses that took place during this event?
2. Who was responsible for the failure in this meeting?
3. What lessons can be learned from this study?
4. In what ways can these mistakes be corrected in future meetings?



Practice

Activity 1: Role-Play

Practice role-playing the given scenario. Take note of the highlighted words and phrases used in this dialogue.

Scenario: A manager is wrapping up a monthly meeting he has just finished for his team. He was providing feedback for the supervisor who is going to conduct his first meeting next month.

Manager: *Hi, Alex! I wanted to share some tips on running effective meetings.*

Alex: *Sure, go ahead!*

Manager: *First, great job on your recent work. Your efforts really stand out.*

Alex: *Thanks!*

Manager: *To manage noise, remind everyone to speak one at a time. It keeps things focused.*

Alex: *That's helpful.*

Manager: *Engage everyone by asking questions. It makes the meeting lively and inclusive.*

Alex: *True, it does.*

Manager: *Finally, ask for feedback at the end. It helps us improve.*

Alex: *Good idea. Maybe we could add quick polls or brainstorming.*

Manager: *Great suggestion, Alex! Let's try that next time.*

Alex: *Sounds good!*

Role-Play Discussions:

1. How effective were the manager's recommendations?
2. According to the manager what is the best way to manage noise?
3. Why was it important to encourage staff to ask questions?
4. Why are quick polls a great way to ask for feedback?

Activity 2: Effective Meeting Management: Cloze Test

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate vocabulary words below:

structure	agenda	engagement	moderation	timekeeping
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1. To ensure a productive meeting, it is essential to have a clear _____ that outlines the topics to be discussed.
2. Effective _____ is crucial to manage discussions and prevent any one person from dominating the conversation.
3. Proper _____ helps keep the meeting on track and ensures that all topics are covered within the allotted time.
4. A well-defined _____ provides a framework for the meeting, making it easier for participants to follow and contribute.
5. Encouraging _____ from all attendees fosters a collaborative environment and ensures diverse perspectives are heard.



Production

CASE STUDY: CHAIR A MEETING

Work in pairs or small groups, reach each scenario and offer solutions to three common issues during disorganized meeting setups.

Scenario 1:

During your presentation in a monthly meeting, you noticed that one member sitting behind the table is constantly checking his mobile phone every minute, making you get distracted by the sound his phone creates.

Analysis Questions:

- *How would you catch his attention and bring him back to the focus of your presentation?*
- *What strategies would you use to ensure that he stops and gets his focus back to the meeting table?*

Scenario 2:

During the feedback session of your monthly meeting, you noticed that one staff member felt offended by your suggestion and was very vocal to disagree with you, creating an intense argument between another member.

Analysis Questions:

- *How would you catch his attention and pacify this heated situation?*
- *What strategies would you use to make him realize the importance of giving feedback about his work progress?*

Discussion:

1. *Looking back at both scenarios, what personal strengths and weaknesses did you notice in your response strategies?*
2. *What would you do differently if you encountered these situations in real life?*



Key Vocabulary

Phrase	Use	Example
<i>Chair a meeting</i>	Used to describe an activity of acting as a leader during an office meeting.	The new manager will <i>chair a meeting</i> about his new plans for the company.
<i>Make agenda</i>	Used to list bullet points about important topics to talk about in a meeting	The VP instructs his secretary to <i>make an agenda</i> for tomorrow's meeting.
<i>Let's move on to</i>	Used as an expression to go to the next topic of a meeting	And now as we are done with slide number 1, <i>let's move on to</i> the next slide of our presentation.
<i>To wrap this meeting up</i>	Used as an expression to end a meeting by summarizing the topics discussed.	If there are no other questions, the secretary is calling the attention of the staff to <i>wrap this meeting up</i> .